

Sony Ericsson K750i

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Tired of my old Nokia 3350 cell phone, I invested in a new Sony Ericsson K750i. The phone is touted as "feature-rich," and it is—but there are a few niggles. And then there's the homelessness you feel when you get away from Nokia—this didn't last too long, though. Anyway, it's been an eventful 30 days...

Day 1:

Robert had just bought a new K750i, and I couldn't buy anything lower—I had to safeguard my geekhood! I first thought of getting myself the W800i, but the price pinched, so I decided to settle for the K750i.

Day 3:

Almost two days with the phone, and I'm still struggling to get out of the Nokia mindset—I stumble on nearly every count! But actually, **the keys are big enough and messaging is quite comfortable**. The dinky joystick is dodgy, however, and sometimes results in false clicks.

The processor is powerful enough to drive the jazzy interface. Just to satisfy the geek in me, I ran JBenckMark v1.0.4, and it returned a score of 3928—which is great!

Day 5:

Things are much easier now that I've become more accustomed to the interface. But the menu structure is simply too long—it was a good 20 minutes before I found the calculator!

Day 9:

I'm trying to get some MP3s onto the phone; **the Bluetooth connection, though convenient, is too slow for my liking, and the bundled 64 MB card is simply not enough**. And despite setting the Music button to default to the media player, I keep getting a message to attach the hands-free—quite silly, considering the phone has a speaker!

Day 10:

I borrowed a 1 GB memory stick and transferred songs to the phone using the DCU-60 cable. The phone is detected as a USB device, though you need to install the drivers and software.

Day 13:

Ram's birthday! A perfect occasion to test the camera. The 2.0 megapixel camera offers a lot of options and feels like a standalone digicam. I clicked 40 pics; my gripe is that **the recording time is slow**—you have to wait and wait before you can click the next picture. Perhaps a firmware upgrade could fix this. **The pictures came out really well**, though, especially the daylight ones, and the night photos were pretty good, too—provided you use the flash.

Day 17:

Power cuts are making life miserable in Mumbai. Thankfully, the K750i has a nice torch feature. And, if you ever get stuck on a lonely island, the blinking LED can send SOS messages in Morse Code! A completely useless feature for most, but completely cool, too!

Day 20:

Playing Java games is a snap on this phone, courtesy the fast processor.

Day 25

I've found a few more firmware glitches, and I need to get the updating client from the Sony Ericsson Web site. Gosh, 33 MB—is this software or bloatware? Later, for updating the firmware, the client insists the phone should be fully charged—Arrrrgh! Anyway, with some perseverance, I finally managed it.

Day 29:

The firmware upgrade has certainly resulted in improvements to the camera. One thing I would love to see happening in the next upgrade is the boosting of **signal reception—it's a tad lower than what Nokia phones offer**. Nevertheless, I'm happy with the K750i. ☑

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